How to play ABYSSLINE

The campaign loop and the decisions to make during your first mission

Complete objectives, bring your six specialists home, and research the way to the source. Reinforcements keep arriving; killing every enemy is unnecessary.

Prepare at command

Material buys equipment, recruits, and emergency containment. **Signal** funds research. **Stability** is your campaign lifeline: reaching zero, or losing every region, ends the campaign. Review Personnel, start a research project, then choose a region and Prepare deployment.

The first six available, active operators deploy. Reserve someone to field another; recruits cost 24 Material, up to 12 living operators. Healthy operators can deploy repeatedly at full accuracy. Injuries and Signal watch assignments make operators unavailable. Missions and Advance cycle progress research, medical recovery, and regional threats.

Spend your two actions deliberately

1. Move and look. Select with the roster or keys 1-6. Blue moves cost 1 AP; gold moves cost 2. Base movement is five tiles, or six for a Diver. Tall structures block sight. Keep cover between you and the enemy.

2. Act with a purpose. Click a hostile to inspect its hit chance, then Fire. Fire, Suppress, Brace, Overwatch and depth charges spend all remaining actions. Move before attacking. Reload, interaction, extraction and other abilities cost 1 AP. Reload restores three rounds. Exposed targets have a 35% critical chance for +2 damage; directional cover reduces accuracy and prevents criticals.

3. Complete the objective and leave. Move adjacent to an objective and Interact, or use the Engineer's Remote link. Return to the green landing zone and Extract each operator separately. Win by completing the objective and extracting at least one operator. Aim to return all six.

Set an ambush; manage the ocean

Most missions begin concealed; Holdout and the final descent begin revealed. Enemies detect within 3 tiles and line of sight, including along your route. Attacks, objectives or noise 4+ reveal the squad. Set Overwatch before the opening shot: enemy groups scatter when activated, triggering reactions. Red tiles warn of known detection zones.

Shots add 3 noise; depth charges add 5. At 7 noise another contact surfaces. Timed reinforcements normally arrive every fourth turn. Every third enemy phase, striped tiles deal 3 flood damage; containment seals reduce squad damage. Each operator has one depth charge: select a contact within 6 tiles, preview, then confirm. It deals 4 damage within radius 1, destroys low cover, and also hurts allies and civilians.

Leave before the deadline. Normal missions allow 17 turns; the final descent allows 20. Anyone still deployed when the window closes or you abandon the operation is lost. In rescue missions, wait until both civilians are safely aboard before your last operator leaves.

Build toward the final descent

Acoustic masking costs 16 Signal and two cycles: noise decays by 3 instead of 1. Complete any two foundational projects, then Deep coordinates (32 Signal, three cycles). Win three operations and finish coordinates to unlock the final descent from an active region.

Controls: F fire · G overwatch · R reload · B brace · V ability · I interact · X extract · Enter end turn. Arrow keys + Space move; Q/E rotate; scroll zooms. The ? button opens the manual. Autosaves are local; export a backup from the campaign menu.

Choosing a region

Choose by urgency first, then by the reward and mission your squad can handle

Choose by breach level, pending threat, mission and reward. Depth is atmospheric. Breach level 3+ adds a starting Brute. The flagged region counters a threat: win there before its three-cycle countdown expires, or the next two operations face +2 enemy HP, +10 enemy aim, or faster timed reinforcements. The briefing names the exact consequence.

Read the next cycle before deploying

After an operation, unattended regions gain **1 breach level**. A new level of 4 or 5 costs **3 Stability**; level 6 means permanent loss and **12 Stability** lost. Success reduces the chosen region by 3 levels and grants 6 Stability before other regions escalate. Failure raises its breach by 1 and costs 14 Stability, plus 12 if it loses the region.

Fund containment costs 20 Material: breach falls by 2 and Stability rises by 4, without advancing time. Protect one region while deploying elsewhere. Advance cycle grants 12 Material and 5 Signal, but escalates every region; weigh research and recovery against that risk.

Region and mission	Reward M / S	Why choose it and what to expect
North Atlantic Containment	34 / 16	A useful first operation. Seal two valves; each seal lowers noise and weakens flood damage to your squad.
Norwegian Sea Civilian rescue	28 / 18	Choose when the region needs help and you can protect an escort route. Two civilians move 3 tiles per enemy phase after rescue.
Indian Ocean Reconnaissance	22 / 26	Best Signal reward for research. Two downloads each add 4 noise and reveal hostiles; plan for extra pressure.
South Pacific Holdout	36 / 18	Strong Material return if your squad can defend. Keep a relay alive for five enemy phases; an Engineer can repair it.
Philippine Trench Sabotage	38 / 14	Highest Material reward for equipment or recruits. Arm two charges; after two enemy phases each hits everything within 2 tiles for 5 damage.
Southern Ocean Emergency extraction	30 / 18	Rescue two wounded divers, who move only 2 tiles per enemy phase. Allow more time for the return journey.

M = Material; S = Signal. Rewards shown are for successful operations. For every mission, complete its objective and extract your operators. Nearby enemies can injure rescued civilians or divers.

A choice you will actually face

North Atlantic is level 5; Indian Ocean is level 2 and counters a threat due in one cycle. Indian Ocean offers research Signal and prevents the modifier, but North Atlantic would be lost. Spend 20 Material to lower North Atlantic to 3, then deploy to Indian Ocean: North Atlantic survives at 4, costing 3 Stability. Without that funding, choose which consequence your campaign can absorb.

Using the six classes

Six specialists, veteran builds, bonds and squad assignments

Everyone can shoot, interact and extract. Abilities cost 1 AP once per turn, except Suppress, which ends the operator's turn. At 4 XP, choose permanent +10 aim or +2 health. At 8 XP, choose one permanent class doctrine below. Stats are before upgrades.

Anchor KEEL

11 HP | 4 damage | range 7. Durable fire support. **Suppress** spends a round, deals 2 damage and cancels the target's next attack; it can still move. Adds 2 noise. Use when a dangerous enemy will survive this turn.
Doctrine: Sentinel adds 2 reaction damage; Bastion makes Brace reduce damage by 3 instead of 2.

Medic PATCH

8 HP | 3 damage | range 6. Field patch heals up to 5 HP to the living ally within 2 tiles with the lowest health percentage, including self. Two charges per mission; no revival. Stay near the squad.
Doctrine: Surgeon heals 7 HP; Triage provides three medical charges.

Diver RIPTIDE

9 HP | 3 damage | range 6. Moves six tiles per action. **Slipstream** adds 3 move range this turn and removes 2 noise. It costs an action: two ordinary moves cover more total ground, but do not lower noise.
Doctrine: Sprinter adds 2 move range; Raider raises exposed-target critical chance to 50%.

Engineer RELAY

9 HP | 3 damage | range 6. Remote link interacts within 4 tiles and line of sight. In Holdout it repairs 4 relay HP, up to 16. Protect this operator to avoid dangerous objective approaches.
Doctrine: Demolition provides two depth charges; Systems extends remote range to 5 and relay repair to 6.

Scout ECHO

8 HP | 3 damage | range 7. Active sonar reveals every hostile for two turns and adds 2 noise. Use before committing to a route. Revealing distant contacts alone does not activate groups or let you shoot through walls.
Doctrine: Pathfinder extends vision from 7 to 9; Silent sonar removes sonar noise.

Marksman GHOST

8 HP | 5 damage | range 10. Steady aim grants the next shot this turn +20 aim and +1 damage. Aim then fire from an established position; moving clears the bonus.
Doctrine: Deadeye adds 1 weapon damage; Hunter adds 15 aim against exposed targets.

Build pairs, reserves and equipment

Bonds: two operators who return from two shared operations can form a mutual bond in Personnel. Deploy both to use Teamwork (T): spend 1 AP to give the partner 1 AP, up to 2. Each pair can transfer once per mission. **Signal watch:** assign one available operator for two cycles; they cannot deploy, then return with +2 XP and +18 Signal for command.

Gear: Silencer (18 M) removes shot noise but loses 1 damage; it still breaks concealment. Plating (22 M) adds 3 HP but loses 1 move range. Research unlocks Capacitor (24 M, +1 damage and +1 shot noise) and Rebreather (16 M, flood immunity and +1 move range).